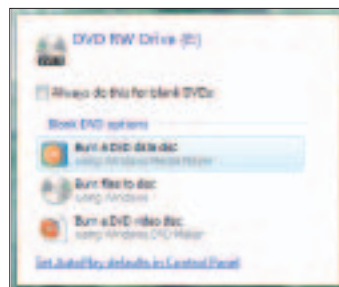


Tip 2

Windows DVD Maker can also create backup data discs. Insert a blank DVD into your drive and an Autoplay window will appear. To perform a backup of files and folders, click on 'Burn files to disc using Windows'. A dialogue box will open asking you to input a disc title. Type in a name, then click on the down-arrow next to 'Show formatting options'. There are two types of data disc that can be created. Choose Live File System and you'll be able to use the DVD like any other kind of data drive, adding and erasing files. DVDs created in this way are not 100 per cent compatible with other operating systems, however. If you want to make sure your disc will be readable in most computers with a DVD drive, choose the second option – Mastered – which still allows you to drag and drop files and folders, but all the files you want to include must be written to the disc at the same time – you can't add or delete later.

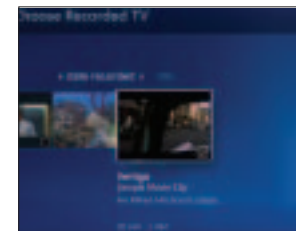
**Tip 3**

Many set-top DVD players and some car stereos can play MP3 and/or WMA music files and it's possible to use Windows' DVD burning capabilities to create a disc of tunes - around 1,000 on a 4.7GB blank DVD. To burn part of your PC's digital music library to disc, insert a blank DVD and, when the Autoplay window appears, select the 'Burn a DVD data disc using Windows Media Player' option. Media Player will launch and you'll notice an icon for your blank DVD in the right-hand pane. Below this is the Burn List. Drag and drop music there from your main library window. When you're done, click **Start Burn** at the bottom of the Burn List.

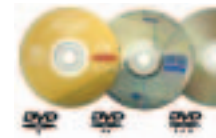
**Tip 4**

You can also burn DVDs through Windows Media Center (only available in Vista Home Premium and Ultimate). With Media Center open and a blank DVD in your drive, navigate the vertical menu until you reach the Tasks option, then go right once to select

'Burn CD/DVD'. Media Center can create three types of DVD: data, video or photo slideshow. To burn a TV show to disc select 'Video DVD', click **Next**, enter a disc title and click **Next** again. On the following screen, put a check next to 'Recorded TV' and click **Next**. Now select the programme(s) you want by ticking the box to the bottom-right of each thumbnail. Click **Next**, then **Burn DVD**.

**Tip 5**

There are several different types of blank DVD – including DVD-R, DVD-RW, DVD+R, DVD+RW and DVD-Ram – and not all burners or set-top players are compatible. Check the loading tray or instruction booklet of your burner and DVD player to try and establish which types of disc can be used. The logos for compatible formats should be clearly shown. The most widely accepted disc format is write-once DVD-R. If in doubt, try burning to this first. If you're having problems with a format you're certain is compatible, you can also try using discs from a different manufacturer, as this can make a surprising difference.

**Tip 6**

Changing some of DVD Maker's settings may also help to solve burning and playback issues. In the main DVD Maker window, click the **Options** link, bottom-right. There are three main things to look at. First, under 'DVD aspect ratio' there are two options. If your movies are looking stretched or squashed when you play them back you may need to switch to either 4:3 (for standard TVs) or 16:9 (for widescreen TVs). Under Video format, you should also make sure that the **Pal** option is selected. If you're having issues with the burning process itself, it may be worth lowering the speed with which files are being written to the disc. Click the dropdown menu next to DVD burner speed and select 'Slow'. Click **OK** to continue.

